Seeing Through Photographs ✕

Today's goal • 3/3 items

Module 1
Introduction to Seeing Through Photographs

Module 2
One Subject, Many Perspectives

Module 3
Documents and the Documentary

Module 4
One and Another

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 4
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Sarah Meister on Photography and Multiplicity
  Video • 2 min

Part II: Albums and Books

- ✓ Artwork Spotlight: Frances Benjamin Johnston's The Hampton Album, 1899-1900
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sarah Meister on Frances Benjamin Johnston. The Hampton Album. 1899-1900
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Photo Books
  Reading • 8 min

Part III: Bodies of Work

- ✓ Photo Series
  Reading • 13 min
- ✓ Hear More: Nicholas Nixon on The Brown Sisters, 1975–2022
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Sohrab Hura on Snow, 2015–ongoing
  Video • 5 min

Part IV: One from Many

- ✓ One from Many
  Reading • 8 min
- ✓ Hear More: Irina Rozovsky on Miracle Center, 2019–ongoing
  Video • 5 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ✓ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 80%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Mid-Course Survey
  Reading • 5 min

Module 5
Constructing Narratives, Challenging Histories

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 5
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artwork Spotlight: Hank Willis Thomas's UNBRANDED series
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Hank Willis Thomas on the Role of Advertising Images
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Re-envisioning History

- ✓ Constructing History
  Reading • 4 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Challenging History
  Reading • 6 min
- ✓ Hear More: Carrie Mae Weems on From Here I Saw What Happened and I Cried, 1995–96
  Video • 2 min
- ✓ Hear More: Walid Raad of The Atlas Group on My neck is thinner than a hair: Engines, 1996–2001
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Harrell Fletcher on The American War, 2005
  Video • 4 min

Part III: Envisioning Selves and Stereotypes

- ✓ Constructing Personal Narratives
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Hear More: Iñaki Bonillas on Constructing Identities
  Video • 5 min
- ✓ Hear More: Eva Respini on Cindy Sherman. Untitled Film Stills. 1977–80
  Video • 1 min
- ✓ Hear More: David Alekhuogie on To Live and Die in LA, 2019
  Video • 4 min

Part IV: Review and Respond

- ✓ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • Grade: 100%
- ✓ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ✓ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 6
Pictures of People

Part I: Introduction

- ✓ Introduction to Module 6
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Artwork Spotlight: Katy Grannan's Portraits
  Reading • 2 min
- ✓ Katy Grannan on Taking Portraits
  Video • 3 min

Part II: Between Subject and Object

- ○ **Exploring Agency**
  Reading • 4 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Susan Meiselas on Carnival Strippers, 1973–75
  Video • 5 min
- ○ Self-Possession
  Reading • 4 min

Part III: Individuals and Types

- ○ Performing Identity
  Reading • 7 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Akram Zaatari on After They Got the Right to Arms. Fourteen young men posing with guns, early 1970s/2006
  Video • 6 min
- ○ Hear More: Stephanie Syjuco on Cargo Cults, 2013–16
  Video • 2 min

Part IV: Strangers and Friends

- ○ Loved Ones
  Reading • 7 min
- ○ Practical Scenario
  Real-world application • 5 min
- ○ Hear More: Tina Barney on Sunday New York Times, 1982
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Hear More: Deana Lawson on Rosie and Raquel, 2010
  Video • 1 min
- ○ Hear More: Maria Antelman on Puzzlers, 2020
  Video • 4 min

Part V: Review and Respond

- ○ Practice Memory Check
  Practice Assignment • 30 min
- ○ Optional Discussion Prompts and Creative Challenges
  Reading • 10 min
- ○ Optional Readings and Resources
  Reading • 10 min

Module 7
Ocean of Images

Exploring Agency

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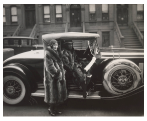
James Van Der Zee

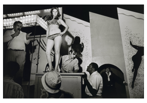


James Van Der Zee. *Couple, Harlem*. 1932. Gelatin silver print, 7 1/2 × 9 5/16" (19 × 23.7 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Richard E. and Laura Salomon. © 2020 Estate of James Van der Zee

Every detail of this portrait—from the couple's luxurious Cadillac V-16 to their stylish his-and-hers raccoon coats—exudes a confidence and prosperity that were rarities in the United States during the Great Depression. This photograph was taken on West 127th Street in Manhattan by James Van Der Zee, the most successful portrait photographer working in Harlem in the 1920s and 1930s. During this period, which was known as the Harlem Renaissance, an influx of African Americans settled in this neighborhood as a result of the Great Migration. Seeking better economic opportunities and safety from the pervasive racial violence of the South, large groups of Black people relocated to the Northeast and made Harlem a center of Black culture in the United States.

Many cosmopolitan urbanites wanted to record their material comforts, social allegiances, and significant life events through photography. While some sitters had their pictures taken in Van Der Zee's well-accessorized studio, other clients requested that the photographer come to their houses, churches, or schools to document weddings, baptisms, sports leagues, and social organizations.

Susan Meiselas

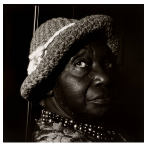


Susan Meiselas. *Lena on the Bally Box, Essex Junction, Vermont* from the series Carnival Strippers. 1973. Gelatin silver print, 7 11/16 × 11 3/4" (19.5 × 29.9 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Acquired through the generosity of Anne Ehrenkranz in honor of Gayle Greenhill. © 2020 Susan Meiselas/Magnum Photos

Aware of the potentially complex ethical relationship between photographer and subject, Susan Meiselas developed an immersive approach through which she gets to know her subjects closely. Carnival Strippers is among her earliest projects and the first in which she became accepted by the community she was documenting.

Over the summers of 1972 to 1975, Meiselas followed an itinerant, small-town carnival, photographing the women who performed in the striptease shows. She captured not only their public performances, but also their private lives. To more fully contextualize the images, Meiselas presented them with audio interviews of the dancers, giving them voice and a measure of control over the way they are presented.

Rosalind Fox Solomon



Rosalind Fox Solomon. *Waiting Room, Baroness Erlanger Hospital, Chattanooga, Tennessee*. 1975. Gelatin silver print, 15 1/2 × 15 1/4" (38.5 × 38.5 cm). The Museum of Modern Art, New York. Gift of the artist. © 2020 Rosalind Solomon

In what was one of her most extensive projects, Rosalind Fox Solomon turned her lens on race relations and the legacy of discrimination in the American South, an endeavour that lasted from the 1970s to 1990s. In 2017, white nationalists and neo-Nazi rally and counter protests in Charlottesville, Virginia inspired her to compile these images into a book called *Liberty Theater*. The book is named after a theater owned by her former husband's family in Chattanooga, Tennessee—in the early 1960s the only theater in the city that was open to people of color. Fox Solomon barely talks to her subjects while photographing them, describing her approach, "Rather than make people feel at ease, I find that some tension between me and the person I am photographing yields something more complex."

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